cognizant

Ace Team

Earn your place



About Cognizant

Ranked
among Fortune's America's Most Innovative Companies
(March 2026)

Certified
as Great Place to Work® in 31 countries, including India
(March 2026)

Recognized
as one of the World's Most Ethical Companies® by Ethisphere
(March 2026)

Ranked
among Newsweek's Most Reliable Companies
(October 2025)

Named
in Forbes' World's Best Employers list 2025
(October 2025)

Ranked
among the World's Best Companies by TIME
(September 2025)

Achieved
a Guinness World Record for the largest online generative AI hackathon
(August 2025)

Recognized
in the Fortune 500 list for the 15th consecutive year and ranked 3rd among pure IT consultancies
(June 2025)

Named
as one of America's Greatest Workplaces and Greatest Workplaces in Tech by Fortune
(June 2025)

Featured
in Newsweek's America's Greatest Workplaces for Gen Z
(May 2025)

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Cognizant® Ace Team 2027

Earn your place on the Cognizant Ace Team!

Job title : Ace Frontier Engineer

Compensation: INR 18 LPA / INR 12 LPA

Job location: PAN India



Job description

Cognizant® Ace Team is Cognizant's premier engineering program that brings together a select group of high-potential AI engineers to solve real-world enterprise challenges using AI-native technologies, agentic systems, and modern engineering practices. As an **Ace Frontier Engineer**, you will operate within a lean, high-impact Frontier pod, building and delivering AI-native solutions end-to-end across software, data, infrastructure, quality, and operations.

In this role, you will design multi-agent systems, build RAG pipelines and knowledge platforms, deploy production-grade LLM applications, and integrate AI-powered workflows across business and technology environments. You will also validate AI-generated outputs, implement guardrails, and ensure reliable AI operations in production.

The program provides exposure to diverse domains, technologies, and problem spaces, enabling rapid growth across agentic AI, LLMOps, AI quality, automation and full-stack engineering. Beyond delivering working solutions, you will be responsible for driving measurable business outcomes and owning what the pod builds in production.

> If you're looking for predictability, this isn't the path. If you're driven to grow into an exceptional engineer and earn your place among the ace, read on.

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Areas of responsibility

Area	What you will do
Frontier Engineering	• Build and orchestrate multi-agent AI systems. • Specify intent prompts for AI coding agents. • Validate AI-generated code for quality and correctness. • Design and build RAG pipelines, vector stores, and knowledge bases • Deploy and operate LLMs, agents, and AI-native applications in production environments.
Solution design & architecture	• Quickly adapt to unfamiliar client environments, domains, and complex problem spaces. • Design AI-native solutions, agentic workflows, and enterprise-scale AI architectures. • Optimize model, reasoning, latency, cost, and business outcome trade-offs. • Establish governance, escalation, and human-AI collaboration patterns for production AI systems. • Design context engineering, retrieval, and grounding strategies to improve AI accuracy and reliability.
Quality & governance	• Validate AI-generated code and outputs for correctness, safety, quality, and relevance. • Integrate AI validation, testing, and quality gates into CI/CD pipelines. • Implement observability, drift monitoring, guardrails, and reliability controls for production AI systems. • Promote Responsible AI through secure, explainable, scalable, and auditable AI solutions. • Monitor agent and model performance, including cost, latency, quality, and operational health.
Delivery & client impact	• Ship AI-native features and production-grade systems at accelerated pace. • Deliver rapid POCs, prototypes, and client demos. • Own solutions end-to-end, from build through production support. • Drive measurable customer outcomes through AI-native solutions.
Communication & collaboration	• Communicate technical concepts to technical and business stakeholders. • Collaborate within Frontier pods across applications, data, infrastructure, and operations. • Validate AI outputs using business and domain context.

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Skills & technologies

Category	Technologies & Skills
Languages & Frameworks	Python, Java / C++ / .NET, JavaScript / TypeScript, React / Angular, REST APIs, SQL
AI & LLM	LLMs & Embeddings, RAG Pipelines, Prompt Engineering & Structured Outputs, LangChain, LangGraph, CrewAI, AutoGen, AI Coding Assistants (GitHub Copilot, Claude), Enterprise Search, Context Engineering, Knowledge Engineering, Multi-Agent Coordination.
Cloud & DevOps	AWS / Azure / GCP, Git, CI/CD pipelines, Containers & cloud-native services,Azure AI Foundry, Vertex AI
AI Evaluation & Ops	AI Quality Metrics, Monitoring, Cost Optimization, OpenTelemetry, AgentOps, Observability, Guardrails, Responsible AI
Good to Have	Vector DB concepts, Streamlit / FastAPI, Kubernetes, Event-driven architectures, AI Experimentation, AI Solution Design

Additional skills

- Students graduating in 2027 with B.E/B. Tech/M.E/M. Tech degrees. Relevant experience in AI-enabled full stack development will be preferred.
- Demonstrated excellence in CS fundamentals and AI/ML projects - through academic work, open-source contributions, hackathons, or personal builds.
- Strong portfolio of AI-enabled or full-stack development projects (academic or personal).
- Genuine curiosity for AI tools, agents, and the future of software engineering.

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Why Ace Team ?



- Client-site deployment from week one -visible impact on live enterprise problems, not a back-office bench role.
- Real AI-native products - build RAG systems, agentic workflows, and LLM-integrated applications on production data.
- Cognizant's AI toolchain & global network - access to cutting-edge platforms and a community of elite engineers across 40+ countries.

- AI-augmented productivity targets - ship at 2x velocity using AI coding assistants, building elite engineering habits from day one.
- Mentorship from senior architects - learn on live transformation programmes, not classroom simulations.
- Clear growth pathway – progression across Frontier Engineer, Master Frontier Engineer, Distinguished Frontier Engineer and Frontier Principal tracks.

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Eligibility criteria



Academic credentials

- Students graduating in 2027 with B.E/B. Tech/M.E/MTech degrees. Relevant experience in AI-enabled full stack development will be an added advantage.
- Students should possess consistent academic record with minimum 60% in X, XII, Diploma UG & PG.
- Appropriate CGPA to % conversion to be considered as per university norms.
- Students with standing arrears are NOT eligible to apply.
- Flexibility to work from any Cognizant office location in a given shift timing and technology is mandatory.
- Open to Indian nationals / OCIs who are currently residing in India.

Note:

- Only one attempt is given for all assessments.
- All students shortlisted for the interview will first be evaluated for Senior Associate level fitment. If they are not selected for the Senior Associate role, their fitment for the Associate role will be assessed during the same interview.
- Interviews will be conducted in-person and students may be required to visit the Cognizant office / nodal college for their interview round as decided by Cognizant.
- Final decision of mapping roles will be based on interview performance and will be at the sole discretion of Cognizant.
- Internship will be offered to a subset of selected candidates based on their academic schedule and the business demand.
- Selected students will be onboarded as full-time employees (FTEs) only after the successful completion of their engineering degree.

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Guidelines



Mandatory documents for registration

- Resume (maximum of 2 pages) with a high - resolution recent passport size photograph. Please note that the photograph should be clicked in a light background and both the ears of the student must be visible.
- Upload your recent photograph on the Superset platform.
- Industry accredited certificates if available.

Mandatory documents for interview

- All academic documents including the college ID card, X, XII, Diploma, UG & PG marksheets.

Mandatory documents for onboarding

- A PAN card is a mandatory requirement for onboarding. If it is not available, please apply for it. Make sure that your last name, father's name and other details are accurate. Please note that background verification will fail if the last name is not updated or if the PAN card name does not match the registered name.
- Passport / Voter ID card is required for verifying nationality while joining Cognizant.
- Aadhar card is mandatory for onboarding.

Important notes for registration

- The name of the student and DOB should exactly match the 10th marksheet and PAN card.
- Enter the appropriate start and end year for all your academic qualifications, including 10th, 12th / Diploma, UG and PG (if applicable). Example: 10th completion year : 2021, 12th completion year : 2023, UG: 2023–2027.
- Mention any prior association with Cognizant—whether through employment, internships, or any association via a third-party vendor.

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- Ensure student registration is completed accurately, as it will be considered final and no changes will be encouraged later. In case any discrepancy is found in the name (refer to the naming convention matrix), scores uploaded, or educational documents provided, the profile will be disqualified.
- All communications to students and TPOs will primarily be through the Superset platform, and students can check and confirm their status directly on the platform.
- A provisional certificate or degree will be mandatory to join Cognizant.

For any placement related queries, please reach out to your placement officer / coordinator and do not write to the email IDs mentioned in the disclaimer below.

Disclaimer:

- In case of any queries related to hiring, interview schedules, or offer communication, kindly reach out to us at Campus2Cognizant.
- Cognizant does not entertain payments of any kind from candidates or vendors for employment. Requests for such payments should be promptly reported to GenCHRComplianceIND@cognizant.com.
- If you encounter anyone who claims to offer jobs at Cognizant in return for any benefit (monetary or non-monetary), please do not entertain them. Please be informed that Cognizant shall not be held responsible for any such instances or payments you make.
- We recommend that you do not respond to spam emails/ messages you do not trust; never disclose your personal or financial details to anyone you do not know. If any such mails purporting to come from Cognizant are received, we advise you to contact us at GenCHRComplianceIND@cognizant.com.
- Cognizant takes its hiring practices seriously and appreciates you keeping the Company informed of any individuals posing as Cognizant employees who make false job offers using Cognizant's name. We remind you that while recruiting employees, Cognizant will only communicate with you through authentic Cognizant email addresses and Cognizant will never extend any job offers to anyone based on an online application without first conducting an in-person, video, or telephone interview through verified encrypted channels. If any such mails purporting to come from Cognizant are received, we advise you to contact us at GenCHRComplianceIND@cognizant.com.
- To ascertain that you are receiving a genuine call from Cognizant, please ensure to collect the recruiter's details (full name; official email ID, employee ID & mobile number) during the call.

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